

Career Rotation Reflection

After applying to the job or internship (or submitting a proposal on Upwork if you chose the freelancing route), answer the following questions.

Summarize your career rotation experience, reflect on what you learned and respond to the questions below. Your submission should be **1-2 pages in length**, providing a thoughtful answer to each question.

When you're done, download as a PDF file and submit it on HQ (To download as a PDF, click: File>Download>PDF Document).

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1. Think back to the projects, companies, and industries you engaged with in this experience. What did you discover? What surprised you? Describe 1-2 main insights or learnings you are taking away.

I worked on an Intel sustainability data deck, a CeraVe SEO/UX project and a social media campaign and A/B test analysis for the Recording Academy. Going into these projects, I initially felt that they dealt with separate skill sets, but what surprised me was how similar the actual work was. In both cases, whether it was Intel's data or the Recording Academy's test results, the job ultimately came down to piecing together a puzzle so someone else could see the full picture at a glance. My main takeaway is that the industry one works in matters less than I thought, and that core skills are what actually determine your potential for success.

2. Describe 1-2 insights you are taking away in terms of refining your understanding of your own strengths, weaknesses, and professional goals. How has this experience changed how you are going to approach your career, or your remaining time in college?

I've always thought of myself as the technical person, given my background in STEM. As a result, I've always believed I was more cut out for activities like coding, designing hardware, or working through technical problems

than for things like marketing or persuasive writing. The CeraVe and Grammy projects showed me that I was capable of that kind of work too, and I actually enjoyed it much more than I expected. In general, I think persuasive writing is still a weak spot for me, as I've already become much more accustomed to writing academic and explanatory pieces. I can explain something clearly, but making a case for it doesn't come as naturally, and that's something I want to actively improve. In the future, I'm not going to isolate myself into a purely technical track. I want roles that mix technical work with communication, since this rotation showed me I can hold my own there and actually enjoy it. For the rest of college, that means being more deliberate about picking up experiences that emphasize both sides of the equation, perhaps things that force me to explain and pitch ideas to people who aren't technical, for example. This also changes my perspective on internships and roles going forward, since instead of only looking at purely engineering positions, I'll pay more attention to roles that value learning via a collaborative mindset.

3. This program included an AI-forward approach and incorporated hands-on Gen AI use to complete professional tasks. In what ways did Gen AI tools support your work across different fields? What did you learn about working with AI from this experience?

I used Gen AI throughout the rotation as a source of inspiration, a tool for designing templates, and a way to organize information so it was easier to construct responses and build out my projects. It helped most when I was staring at a blank page, whether that was structuring a deck, drafting a write-up, or figuring out how to lay out a template. The biggest thing I learned is that AI is especially powerful as a starting point. It excels at providing a structure or an angle to react to, but the actual thinking and refining still has to come from the individual. AI was especially useful when I gave it context, since I'd sometimes lose track of details from earlier in a project or get confused about what a task actually required. Being able to hand that context back to it and receive an answer saved me from having to claw through everything myself again in many instances. This enhanced

my efficiency greatly, allowing me to complete projects quickly without sacrificing quality.

4. What career opportunity did you apply to? How did it feel? How has your Accelerator experience prepared you for this application process? What will you do differently the next time you apply?

I applied to Love's Alternative Energy's Engineering Internship in Alternative Fuels for Summer 2027, based in Houston, which I discovered via Handshake. The role is on their Design Build Services team, working on CNG, hydrogen, EV charging, and solar projects, which falls under the clean energy space. This one required a cover letter, not just a resume, so it took significantly more effort than most of the other applications I sent out. Writing the letter made me ponder how to connect my experience to what the company actually does. My E-Truck Club work is rooted in automotive systems, not alternative fuels, so I had to actively find the relationship between the two. It felt fulfilling to submit, but also made me understand how much more effort each application takes when there's a cover letter involved versus a quick resume submission, which was thankfully more often the case.

The Accelerator helped in the application process in an indirect manner, though its impact was significant. The resume work taught me how to list my accomplishments with measurable outcomes instead of just listing responsibilities, use strong action words to take ownership, and format things so they're both ATS-friendly and visually clean for hiring managers to scan. Having already gone through that process on my resume made it easier to pull the right material together for the cover letter instead of starting from a blank slate. Writing the cover letter was somewhat tedious, but in the future, I believe keeping a bank of paragraphs I can adapt (depending on context) instead of rewriting the connection between my experience and the role from scratch each time could prove to be an efficient and effective approach.

